ADR NNNN — <title>

Status: Proposed | Accepted | Deprecated | Superseded by ADR-NNNN **Date**: YYYY-MM-DD **Author**: <name> **Related**: ADR-NNNN, docs/...

Context

What is the problem this decision addresses? What forces are at play (technical, business, team)? What's the constraint set?

Keep it factual — describe the situation, not the solution yet.

Decision

What did we decide? State it in one or two sentences first, then expand with concrete specifics.

If the decision involves a schema, contract, or interface, include the actual shape inline (or link to the schema file).

Reasoning

Why this decision over the alternatives? What forced the choice? What did we optimise for?

This is the section that gets quoted under interview drilling. Make it defensible.

Alternatives considered

For each alternative seriously considered:

Alternative A — <name>

- What it would have looked like
- Why we rejected it (specific, not "didn't like it")

Alternative B — <name>

- Same structure

Consequences

What happens as a result of this decision?

- **Positive**: what gets easier / better
- **Negative**: what gets harder / worse / locks us in
- **Neutral**: changes that aren't strictly better or worse

Open questions / follow-ups

Things this decision deliberately leaves for later. Link to issues, tickets, or future ADRs.

References

- Papers, docs, prior art that informed the decision
- Related ADRs in this project
- External standards (RFCs, JSON Schema specs, etc.)

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